WF

CHRISTMAS 2026 EDITION

WILEY FOX TRAVEL
FAMILIES AND SOLO TRAVELLERS



THE WILEY FOX GUIDE TO

Prague

For families & solo travellers

4

WILEY FOX RATING · LOW
OUT OF 5 · POLICE DATA JAN 2025 TO DEC 2025
CREATOR FEELING 4/5 · SAFE AND FRIENDLY - WATCH YOUR MONEY AND THE CROWDS

28 Nov

OLD TOWN & WENCESLAS MARKETS OPEN

To 6 January 2027, 10:00-22:00 (organiser). Náměstí Míru opens on 20 November.

-9%

CRIME IN PRAGUE, 2025

The biggest fall of any Czech region (Czech Statistical Office).

79

CREATORS · 139 VIDEOS

Paraphrased and credited, cross-checked with official sources.

Prague's historic centre straddles the Vltava. On the east bank are the Old Town (Staré Město), with the Old Town Square and the Astronomical Clock, the Jewish Quarter (Josefov) and the New Town (Nové Město) around Wenceslas Square; Charles Bridge crosses to the Lesser Town (Malá Strana) and up the hill to Prague Castle. The centre is compact and walkable but cobbled and hilly on the castle side, and trams and three metro lines cover the rest. Creators suggest three or four days.

At Christmas the two big markets on the Old Town Square and Wenceslas Square run from the last Saturday of November into January, and the Old Town tree lights up to music every hour after dark. Smaller, cheaper markets fill local squares - Náměstí Míru in Vinohrady is the locals' favourite. A lamplighter lights the gas lamps on Charles Bridge in the weeks before Christmas, and there are rinks, concerts and a free children's programme at the main market.

For solo travellers Prague feels safe and friendly, and English is widely spoken. Plan for packed streets in December (especially weekends), dark afternoons from about 4pm, icy cobbles, and the money traps: pay by card in koruna, never change money on the street, and use a ride app instead of a street taxi. Large shops close at noon on 24 December and all day on 25 and 26 December.

WF

Czechia doesn't publish street-level crime data, so before you book, check your hotel's street on the Wiley Fox map and in community reports. Creators steer families away from Dlouhá Street, the top of Wenceslas Square and the streets around the main station.

Fast facts

CURRENCY	Czech koruna (CZK) - about 24.4 to the euro (Czech National Bank, Oct 2026). Pay by card in koruna; euros are taken in some tourist places at poor rates
LANGUAGE	Czech - English is widely spoken in the centre
TIME ZONE	Central European Time (UTC+1) - one hour ahead of the UK
PLUG	Type E, 230V - UK plugs need an adaptor
EMERGENCY	112 all services · 158 police · 155 ambulance · 150 fire · 156 city police
ENTRY	UK passport issued less than 10 years before arrival and valid 3+ months after you leave the Schengen area; up to 90 days in any 180. EES fingerprint and photo checks at the border - creators report long Christmas queues at the airport
TIPPING	About 10% for good service, or round up - check first whether a service charge is already on the bill
BEST TIME	Weekdays from 28 November, early mornings and evenings; avoid Advent weekends in the Old Town

THE FESTIVE SEASON

Christmas in Prague

Prague's two big Christmas markets, on the Old Town Square and Wenceslas Square, open on Saturday 28 November 2026 and run to 6 January 2027. They are pretty, food-heavy and very crowded, and both are run by the same company. The smaller markets in local squares - Náměstí Míru, Republic Square, Tylovo náměstí - are cheaper, more local and mostly close on 24 December. Prague also does the Christmas traditions well: a lamplighter on Charles Bridge, carol singers on church steps and fried carp on Christmas Eve.

Christmas markets



Old Town Square (Staroměstské náměstí)

STARÉ MĚSTO · 28 NOV 2026 - 6 JAN 2027 · 10:00-22:00 · GREAT FOR KIDS

The famous one, framed by the Týn Church and the Astronomical Clock, with a big real tree that lights up to music every hour from 16:30 to 21:30, a stage, a raised viewing walkway and children's craft workshops at weekends (latest year). Almost all food and drink: sausages, Prague ham, potato pancakes, garlic-cheese dumplings, honey wine. Stalls take cards.

Crowds: The most crowded market - creators found it hard to move on opening weekend and on Saturdays. Go on a weeknight or by day, or watch the tree from a restaurant at the edge of the square.

Via Dave Mani, Prowalk Tours, Here's Good, Postcard And A Pint, Abby and Logan Travel, Real Prague Guides, Nate and Katrina Do the World, Bérénice Achille - Travel Creator, Jumping Places

Free entry · mulled wine about CZK 100, sausage CZK 160 (2024-25)

DETAILS



Wenceslas Square (Václavské náměstí)

NOVÉ MĚSTO · 28 NOV 2026 - 6 JAN 2027 · 10:00-22:00 · GREAT FOR KIDS

Five to eight minutes from the Old Town, along the lower end of the boulevard towards Můstek (tram works have shortened it), with a big tree, an ice rink and more room to walk. Food-focused: corn and Pilsner, potato pancakes, chimney cakes. **Crowds:** Busy but more laid-back than the Old Town, with shorter queues. The paving gets icy at night.

Via Here's Good, Nate and Katrina Do the World, Postcard And A Pint, Never Two Full, Nash & Tereza, Real Prague Guides, Bérénice Achille - Travel Creator

Free entry · potato pancake CZK 130 (2025)

DETAILS



Náměstí Míru

VINOHRADY · 20 NOV - 24 DEC 2026 · CLOSES AFTER LUNCH ON 24 DEC · GREAT FOR KIDS

The locals' favourite, in front of St Ludmila church: trees decorated by schools, traditional Czech Christmas biscuits, handmade gifts, langoš, and carol singers on

the church steps in the evening. Two metro stops from the centre on line A.

Crowds: Busy after work, but mostly locals.

Via Real Prague Guides, Postcard And A Pint, Never Two Full, Nash & Tereza, Bérénice Achille - Travel Creator, Tohl Time

Free entry · mulled wine about CZK 80 (2024) · some stalls cash only

DETAILS



Photo: Anaj7 · CC BY-SA 4.0

Republic Square (Náměstí Republiky)

NOVÉ MĚSTO · 25 NOV - 24 DEC 2026 · GREAT FOR KIDS

Two small markets of about 20 stalls each, by the Palladium shopping centre and the Municipal House, five minutes from the Old Town. Street-food-heavy and cheaper: mulled wine about CZK 60-65, goulash in a bread bowl.

Crowds: Calmer than the big two.

Via The Traveling ZAM, Real Prague Guides, Postcard And A Pint, WonderJourneys, Nash & Tereza

Free entry

DETAILS

Tylovo náměstí

VINOHRADY / NOVÉ MĚSTO · 26 NOV - 24 DEC 2026 · GREAT FOR KIDS

A small, overlooked market with good prices on Christmas biscuits - a quick hot-drink stop near I. P. Pavlova.

Crowds: Quiet.

Via Real Prague Guides, Sara Goes Local

Free entry

DETAILS



Photo: Dezidor · CC BY-SA 3.0

Jiřího z Poděbrad

VINOHRADY / ŽIŽKOV · USUALLY LATE NOVEMBER TO JUST BEFORE CHRISTMAS (2026 DATES NOT YET PUBLISHED) · GREAT FOR KIDS

A small, relaxed market under the striking church, with pastries, gifts and cheap mulled wine, plus the regular farmers' market.

Crowds: Local and relaxed.

Via Real Prague Guides, Nash & Tereza

Free entry

DETAILS

Na Kampě & Malá Strana

MALÁ STRANA · DECEMBER (2026 DATES NOT YET PUBLISHED) · GREAT FOR KIDS

A tiny food-only market down the steps at the end of Charles Bridge, with a small tree, a wooden nativity, more seating and lots of non-alcoholic drinks. Paper cups, no mugs.

Crowds: Quiet - a rest from the bridge.

Via The Traveling ZAM, Bérénice Achille - Travel Creator, Tohl Time

Free entry

DETAILS



Photo: Perituss · CC0

Havelské tržiště & Mariánské náměstí

STARÉ MĚSTO · DAILY, WITH CHRISTMAS STALLS IN DECEMBER · GREAT FOR KIDS

The year-round street market between the Old Town and Wenceslas Square adds ornaments, gingerbread and mulled wine at about half the big-market price (CZK 65 in 2024), and a small craft market sits at Mariánské náměstí by the Klementinum.

Crowds: Much less crowded than the square five minutes away.

Via Tohl Time, The Traveling ZAM, Bérénice Achille - Travel Creator

Free entry

DETAILS



Photo: I would appreciate being notified if you use my work outside Wikimedia. More of my work can be found in my personal gall · CC ...

Anděl

SMÍCHOV · DECEMBER (2026 DATES NOT YET PUBLISHED)

A lively, hectic local market with live music and lots of meat, by the Anděl shopping area. No tree. Trams 10 or 16, or metro B.

Crowds: Busy with locals after work; the area gets rowdy late.

Via Real Prague Guides

Free entry

DETAILS

Lights, rinks and festive sights

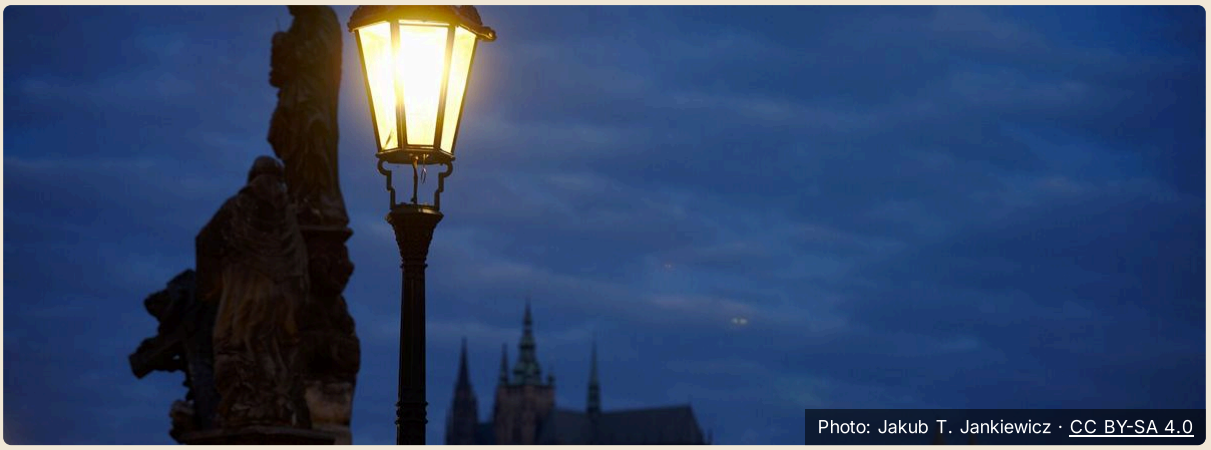


Photo: Jakub T. Jankiewicz · CC BY-SA 4.0

The Charles Bridge lamplighter

CHARLES BRIDGE · DAILY IN DECEMBER TO 23 DEC, AROUND 4PM (CREATORS, 2024-25) · GREAT FOR KIDS

A costumed lamplighter lights the bridge's gas lamps one by one at dusk. Big crowds gather, so arrive a little early - and check your tram number so you don't miss it.

Crowds: Crowded at dusk.

Via Sara Goes Local, Nash & Tereza, Jenix Travel Vlogs, Nate and Katrina Do the World, Abby and Logan Travel

Free

DETAILS



Photo: Karelj · Public domain

Advent at Prague Castle

HRADČANY · LATE NOVEMBER TO EARLY JANUARY (2025 PROGRAMME; 2026 NOT YET PUBLISHED) · GREAT FOR KIDS

A tree by St Vitus and an Advent programme with special openings. Creators say the castle has had no proper Christmas market in recent years. The buildings close on 24 December.

Crowds: Very busy; long queues at Golden Lane.

Via Nate and Katrina Do the World, Postcard And A Pint, Nash & Tereza

Grounds free

DETAILS

Ice skating

WENCESLAS SQUARE & THE RIVERBANK · WENCESLAS SQUARE RINK 1 DEC - 15 FEB (2025/26) · GREAT FOR KIDS

A rink on Wenceslas Square and others around the city, including one on a boat at Náplavka by the Dancing House (about €6 plus €6 skate hire in 2024). Helpers are on hand for beginners at some rinks.

Crowds: Busiest at weekends.

Via Nash & Tereza, Real Prague Guides, Jumping Places

About CZK 200 for 2 hours (2023)

DETAILS



Photo: Jan Fidler from Prague, Czech Republic · CC BY 2.0

New Year's Eve

OLD TOWN & THE RIVER · 31 DEC 2026

There is no official city fireworks display, and fireworks are banned in the historic centre, near the river and in parks (on-the-spot fines up to CZK 10,000) - but people

set them off anyway around Wenceslas Square, the Old Town Square and Charles Bridge. With young children, see the new year in from a hotel or restaurant.
Crowds: Very crowded around midnight; the walkway in the Old Town Square closes 22:00-09:00.

Via Jenix Travel Vlogs, Sharing the Road

Free

DETAILS

Staying safe in the Christmas crowds

Crowds and timing

December is Prague's busiest month - over 600,000 visitors, creators say. The Old Town market fills up towards the weekend; weeknights and daytimes are calmer, and the smaller squares stay manageable all month.

Via Prowalk Tours, Here's Good, Postcard And A Pint, Dave Mani

Police and barriers

Police step up uniformed and armed patrols at the markets every Advent, and concrete barriers protect the Old Town, Wenceslas Square and Republic Square markets (2024, latest year published). The UK Foreign Office says terrorist attacks in Czechia can't be ruled out.

Source: Czech police / official sources

Pickpockets

Watch bags in the queues and on the viewing walkway, at the clock on the hour, and on tram 22. Don't leave phones on café tables. Report a theft at a police station within 24 hours for insurance - the one at Jungmannovo náměstí 9 is open 24 hours with interpreters.

Via Real Prague Guides, HONEST GUIDE, Wolters World

Prices and payment

Mulled wine was about CZK 100 at the big markets and CZK 60-80 at the smaller ones (2024-25); sweet waffles about CZK 120-180. The big markets take cards; Náměstí Míru stalls were cash only. Food is often priced per 100 g.

Via Here's Good, The Traveling ZAM, Real Prague Guides, Tohl Time

Have a lost-child plan

Agree a meeting point everyone can find - the tree on the Old Town Square or the statue of St Wenceslas at the top of the

Cold, dark and icy

Highs around 4°C, nights below freezing, dark by 4:30pm, and slippery cobbles.

square. A Wiley Fox QR wristband on each child means anyone who finds them can reach you straight away.

Source: Czech police / official sources

Waterproof boots with grip, gloves and a hat; plan sights for the morning.

Via Nash & Tereza, Let's Go! Travel Tips, Chris Rodriguez

In 2026 the Náměstí Míru market opens on 20 November and the Old Town and Wenceslas Square markets on Saturday 28 November, running to 6 January 2027 (10:00-22:00). The smaller markets close on 24 December. Large shops close at noon on 24 December and all day on 25 and 26 December, the castle buildings are shut on 24 December, and public transport runs a reduced holiday timetable. Book hotels, restaurants and concerts early.

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Clip a Wiley Fox QR wristband on each child. If you get separated in the crowd on Charles Bridge or at the Old Town tree, anyone who scans it can contact you straight away - no app needed on their side.

WHAT THE DATA AND THE CREATORS SAY

How it feels, and what the numbers show

The data

Prague is a calm city for visitors: creators - solo women and families included - felt safe day and night, and local guides say there are no no-go areas. The risks are pickpocketing in crowds and losing money to traps rather than to crime. Czech police registered 34,853 crimes in Prague in 2025, down 9% on 2024: 2,492 per 100,000 residents, about 1.6 times the Czech average, which the statistics office puts down partly to tourists and commuters being counted as victims but not as residents. Violent crime (115 per 100,000) is level with the regions around Brno and Plzeň and below Ostrava's. Pickpocketing makes up about 9% of Prague's property crime - a far bigger share than elsewhere in the country - and the UK Foreign Office warns of it on airport transport, the trams to the castle and in busy tourist areas. The other danger creators stress is the trams: heavy, fast and with right of way. This rating is for the city as a whole: Czechia does not publish street-level crime data.

The creators

Creators repeatedly call Prague one of the safest cities in Europe, and several solo women walked home late at night without worry. Local guides say genuine scams are now rare and the topic is overblown; what does happen is street money-changers handing over worthless notes, exchange offices with terrible rates, overpriced street taxis, food sold by weight and restaurants that add a service charge. In December the Old Town, Charles Bridge and the castle are packed, especially at weekends. A few places get rowdy after dark - the bottom of Wenceslas Square, the park by the main station, Dlouhá Street and around Anděl.

What the official figures say

Figures are from the Czech Statistical Office's crime publication (June 2026), which republishes Czech Police data for 2025, cross-checked against the police's own regional table. Prague is both a city and a region, so these are city figures. Rates are the statistics

office's own, per 100,000 residents at mid-year. 2025 in Prague: all registered crime 34,853 (-9.3%), property crime 23,270 (-9.4%), violent crime 1,609 (+0.8%), robbery 204 (+12.7%), home burglary 724 (-1.0%). Czech law counts many small thefts as minor offences rather than crimes, and the police clear only 27% of Prague cases (the lowest of 14 regions, because most are anonymous property crimes), so compare Prague only with other Czech regions, not with other countries. Czechia publishes no street-level data, so this guide's map shows the markets and sights and the places creators and police name. On New Year's Eve 2025/26 Prague 1 reported no serious incidents; police logged 269 reports in the district, 54 of them about fireworks.

-9%

REGISTERED CRIME IN PRAGUE (2025)

34,853 crimes, the biggest fall of any Czech region; 2,492 per 100,000 residents against 1,561 nationally (ČSÚ).

115

VIOLENT CRIMES PER 100,000 RESIDENTS (2025)

Level with South Moravia (112) and Plzeň (121), below Moravia-Silesia (150).

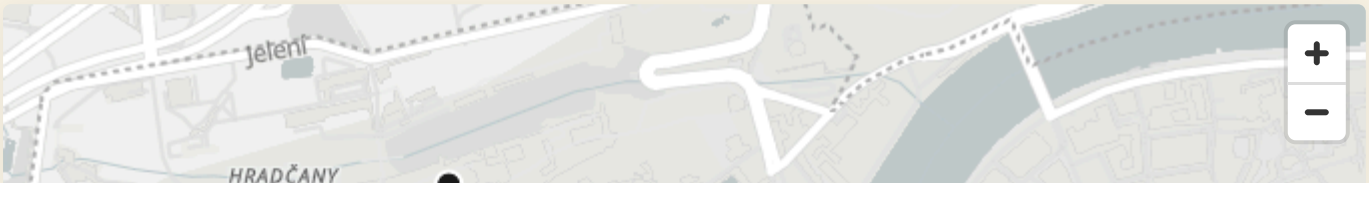
9%

PICKPOCKETING'S SHARE OF PRAGUE PROPERTY CRIME

Against about 1-2% in smaller regions - the clearest sign of where the risk is (ČSÚ 2025).

Map: markets, sights and places to take care

Czechia doesn't publish street-level crime data, so this map shows the markets and sights in this guide, the busiest crowd spots and the places creators and police name.





Crime figures: Czech Statistical Office / Police of the Czech Republic - registered crime 2025 · Open the Wiley Fox map

How Prague compares with the rest of Czechia

Crimes registered by police in 2025 per 100,000 residents. Prague is both a city and a region; the other rows are regions, so they include Brno, Ostrava and Plzeň plus the countryside around them. Prague's overall rate is the highest in the country - mostly property crime, and inflated by visitors who are counted as victims but not as residents - while its violent-crime rate is close to the national average.

	ALL REGISTERED CRIME	VIOLENT CRIME	ROBBERY
South Moravia (incl. Brno)	1,443	112	11.3
Plzeň region	1,512	121	12.4
Moravia-Silesia (incl. Ostrava)	1,803	150	18.6
Prague	**2,492**	**115**	**14.6**
Czechia average	*1,561*	*126*	*12.3*

per 100,000 residents, 2025

All-crime rates are the Czech Statistical Office's own; violent crime and robbery rates are Wiley Fox's calculations from the office's counts and its population base. Czech law treats many small thefts as minor offences rather than crimes, so these rates are not comparable with other countries' figures. Source: Czech Statistical Office - Kriminalita 2015-2025 (Police ČR data)

Areas to take extra care

None of these are no-go areas. Know the pattern, and plan your timing and your route home.

- **Astronomical Clock, Old Town Square and Charles Bridge**
  TAKE MOST CARE: DECEMBER AFTERNOONS, EVENINGS AND WEEKENDS

  The crowd hotspots, and where creators and the UK Foreign Office warn of pickpockets - also on tram 22 to the castle and on airport transport. Most phones and wallets go when they are left on café and restaurant tables. Keep bags zipped and in front, and agree a meeting point with children.

  Via Real Prague Guides, Wolters World, Destination Well Known, HONEST GUIDE

- **Trams and road crossings**
  TAKE MOST CARE: ALWAYS

  Trams have right of way, often don't stop at crossings without lights and need several metres to brake. Local guides say this is the real physical danger in Prague. Hold children's hands at tram tracks, and don't dash across the six-lane road at the main station.

  Via HONEST GUIDE, Real Prague Guides

- **Wenceslas Square, Dlouhá Street and Anděl at night**
  TAKE MOST CARE: LATE EVENINGS AND WEEKENDS

  Clubs, drunk crowds and touts at the bottom of Wenceslas Square, where a local guide links some bars to overcharging and, rarely, spiked drinks; rowdy bars around Dlouhá; and crowds around Anděl station. Don't follow touts, check prices, and use an app taxi home.

  Via Real Prague Guides, Destination Well Known

- **The park by the main station (Vrchlického sady)**
  TAKE MOST CARE: AFTER DARK

  Creators say phones and wallets go missing here after dark, though it is cleaner than it was. Use the station's main entrances and the lifts rather than cutting through.

  Via Real Prague Guides

- **Ticket inspections**
  TAKE MOST CARE: ALWAYS

No barriers, but plain-clothes inspectors check often, especially at the Petřín funicular. An unvalidated ticket counts as none: the fine is CZK 1,200 on the spot or CZK 1,500-2,000 later (2026). Activate app tickets before you board - there's no signal underground.

Via Real Prague Guides, Happy to Wander (Travel Tips & Inspo), Nash & Tereza, Carol & Max, HONEST GUIDE

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The big markets close at 10pm and trams thin out late. Save your hotel on Wiley Fox, use an app taxi rather than a street one, and keep SOS one tap away on the walk back.

Scams and tricks creators keep seeing

Street money-changers

People outside exchange offices, by cash machines, at ticket machines (some in orange vests) and even at the airport bus stop offer a 'good rate' and hand over worthless foreign or old notes. Never change money on the street - pay by card.

Via HONEST GUIDE, Real Prague Guides, Destination Well Known

'0% commission' exchange offices

Commission is banned by law, so the sign means nothing: the cost is in the rate. Creators saw 17 to 25 koruna per euro on the same street. You can cancel an exchange within 3 hours at the same office (Czech National Bank).

Via HONEST GUIDE, Real Prague Guides, Wolters World

Cash machines and card terminals

Avoid Euronet and other independent cash machines in the Old Town, and always choose koruna when a machine offers your home currency - one creator saw a €175 fee on a withdrawal.

Via HONEST GUIDE, Carol & Max, Wolters World

Street taxis

Taxis waiting at the main station, the airport rank and in the Old Town have overcharged - one hidden-camera ride cost 750 CZK against 231. Use Bolt, Uber or Liftago for an upfront price. The airport's own fare guide is about CZK 800 to the centre.

Via HONEST GUIDE, Toughest, Nash & Tereza, Real Prague Guides, Carol & Max

Food sold by weight

Prague ham and other market dishes are priced per 100 g and weighed after cutting

Tourist-trap restaurants

Tented restaurants on the Old Town Square and some on Wenceslas Square charge

- 300 g came to 387 CZK. Ask for a weight (say 150 g) and the total before they cut.

Via Real Prague Guides, Never Two Full, Nate and Katrina Do the World

about four times local prices, add 12-15% service, serve a 'large beer' as a litre, and charge for bread. Check the menu and the bill; a daily lunch menu a street away costs half.

Via Nash & Tereza, HONEST GUIDE, Wolters World, Real Prague Guides

Fake police

The UK Foreign Office warns of fake plain-clothes police asking to see your money and passport. Real officers can't demand to see your cash - offer to go to a police station or call 112.

Source: Czech police / official sources

NEIGHBOURHOODS

Where to stay

Pick an area first, then a hotel. The old town is compact, so most bases are within a short walk of the markets.



Photo: TxllxtTxllxT · CC BY-SA 4.0

Staré Město (Old Town)

FIRST-TIMERS · CHRISTMAS MARKETS · WALKING

Everything is on the doorstep, and creators suggest it for winter because daylight is short and the hilly Lesser Town gets slippery. It is the priciest and noisiest area: pick a calm street or a courtyard room, and avoid Karlova, Kaprova and the party street Dlouhá. Mid-range hotels from about $80-150 a night outside peak dates (2026).

Via Real Prague Guides, Nash & Tereza, Destination Well Known, The Ultimate Travel Guide, CORR Travel Europe Your Way



Photo: Ввласенко · CC BY-SA 3.0

Malá Strana (Lesser Town)

COUPLES · FAMILIES · QUIET NIGHTS

Baroque streets under the castle, over Charles Bridge. Very quiet at night - embassies, no clubs - and a family with a toddler loved it in January. The catch is hills and cobbles, which are hard with a pushchair or in snow; choose a hotel near a tram stop.

Via Destination Well Known, Real Prague Guides, Nash & Tereza, Walshy's Travels, ViaTravelers

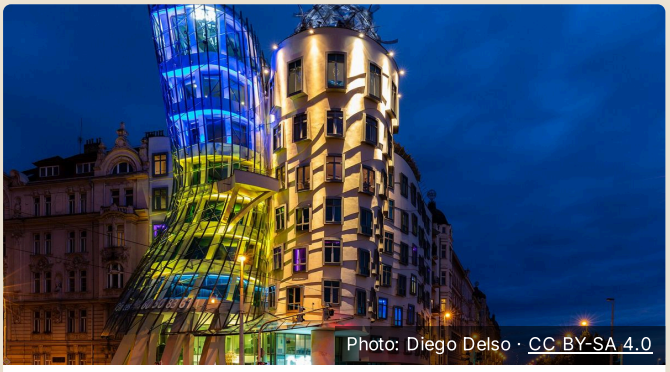


Photo: Diego Delso · CC BY-SA 4.0

Vinohrady

FAMILIES · SOLO TRAVELLERS · LOCAL LIFE

Leafy, residential and a few metro stops from the centre, with the locals' Christmas

Nové Město (New Town)

FAMILIES · GOOD VALUE · TRANSPORT

The best mid-range choice, 20-30% cheaper than the Old Town and a short walk from it, with metro and trams everywhere: about $55-100 a night (2026). Quieter pockets are around Charles Square, the Dancing House and the Powder Tower; avoid the hotels on Wenceslas Square itself, which stay loud late.

Via The Ultimate Travel Guide, MultiCityTrips, Destination Well Known, Real Prague Guides, Nash & Tereza

markets at Náměstí Míru and Jiřího z Poděbrad, parks and good cafés. Mostly apartments and guesthouses, about $45-120 a night (2025-26).

Via The Traveler's Atlas, ViaTravelers, Exotic Vacation, The Ultimate Travel Guide, Carol & Max



Photo: Daniel Baránek · CC BY-SA 3.0

Holešovice

FAMILIES · BUDGET · MUSEUMS

A former industrial district five to ten minutes from the centre by tram, with Letná and Stromovka parks and the National Technical Museum for children. International trains from Berlin stop here.

Via Nash & Tereza, MultiCityTrips, ViaTravelers, Real Prague Guides



Photo: VitVit · CC BY-SA 4.0

Dejvice (Prague 6)

QUIET NIGHTS · FAMILIES · EARLY FLIGHTS

Residential, calm and cheaper, on metro line A and handy for the airport bus. If you stay further out, creators say pick somewhere on the metro rather than relying on buses.

Via Nash & Tereza, Real Prague Guides

Hotels we'd start with

> Wiley Fox may earn a small commission if you book through these links. Your price stays the same.

MALÁ STRANA · LUXURY WITH CHILDREN

Augustine, a Luxury Collection Hotel

A 13th-century monastery on a quiet street a short walk from Charles Bridge. A family stayed three nights with a two-year-old in January and loved the breakfast and the calm (2026).

€€€€ PRICE BAND

SEE PRICES

Via Walshy's Travels

NOVÉ MĚSTO · FAMILIES

Hotel Cube Prague

Modern hotel on a quiet street with spacious rooms, 10 minutes' walk to the Old Town; about $130-170 a night (2025).

€€€ PRICE BAND

SEE PRICES

Via Love Hard Travel Harder

KAMPA, MALÁ STRANA · COUPLES

Pytloun Garden Hotel

Quiet hotel on Kampa island with river or castle views, steps from Charles Bridge; about $130-170 a night (2025).

€€€ PRICE BAND

SEE PRICES

Via Love Hard Travel Harder

STARÉ MĚSTO · CLOSE TO THE MARKETS

Hotel Residence Agnes

Boutique hotel with attentive service on a calmer Old Town street, walking distance to the Astronomical Clock; from about $150 a night (2026).

€€€ PRICE BAND

SEE PRICES

Via Happy Travel Corner

NOVÉ MĚSTO, BY THE NATIONAL THEATRE · SOLO TRAVELLERS

Mosaic House Design Hotel

Eco design hotel a block from the tram; a solo traveller found the staff friendly and the rooms simple but comfortable; about $100-140 a night (2025).

€€ PRICE BAND

SEE PRICES

Via Chelsea Zeferina

HOLEŠOVICE · GOOD VALUE

Mama Shelter Prague

Fun modern hotel with a direct tram into the centre in about 15 minutes; about $80-110 a night (2025).

€€ PRICE BAND

SEE PRICES

Via Love Hard Travel Harder

Search all Prague hotels

Compare live prices, then check the street on the Wiley Fox map before you book.

SEARCH BOOKING.COM

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Clip a Wiley Fox QR wristband on each child. If you get separated in the crowd on Charles Bridge or at the Old Town tree, anyone who scans it can contact you straight away - no app needed on their side.

WHAT CREATORS RATE

Ten things worth your time

Ranked by how often creators recommend them. Go early: Charles Bridge and the castle are packed by mid-morning in December, and the castle's visitor buildings close at 4-5pm in winter and all day on 24 December.



Photo: Roman Boed from The Netherlands · CC BY 2.0

01 *Charles Bridge*

STARÉ MĚSTO / MALÁ STRANA · GREAT FOR KIDS

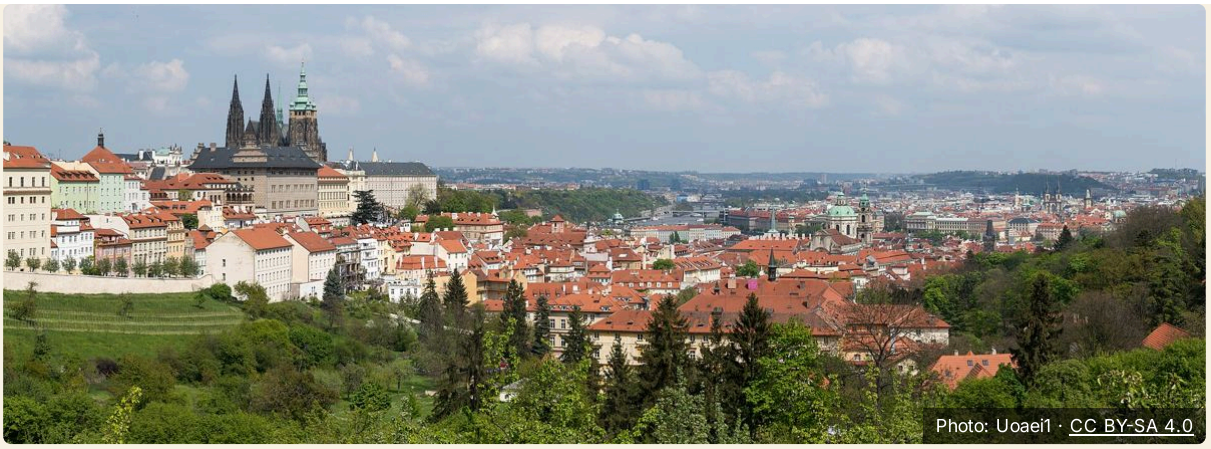
The 14th-century stone bridge lined with statues, with the castle above. In December it is chaotic by day and impassable on weekend evenings; creators go at sunrise or 7am. Before Christmas a lamplighter lights the gas lamps by hand around 4pm.

Via Real Prague Guides, Kristina's Travels, Walshy's Travels, Nate and Katrina Do the World, Sara Goes Local, Gone Again

Free

DETAILS

02



Prague Castle & St Vitus Cathedral

HRADČANY · GREAT FOR KIDS

The world's largest castle complex. The courtyards are free, with the changing of the guard at noon; the main circuit covers the cathedral, the Old Royal Palace and Golden Lane. Go before 9:30, buy on site rather than from resellers, and know the gardens are shut in winter and the buildings close on 24 December.

Via Nash & Tereza, Real Prague Guides, Sharing the Road, Kristina's Travels, Jess Ellis, Shea Jordan, Resty Neha Vlogs

Grounds free · circuit CZK 450, child CZK 300, family CZK 950

DETAILS

03



Old Town Hall tower & Astronomical Clock

OLD TOWN SQUARE · GREAT FOR KIDS

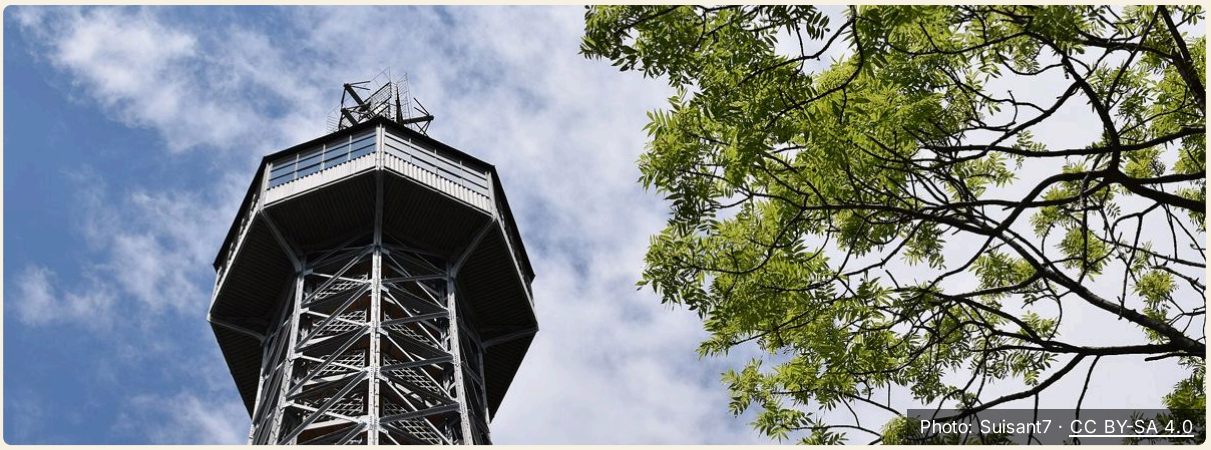
The medieval clock's apostles parade on the hour - it lasts under a minute, so stand facing it and don't plan your day round it. The tower has a lift and the best view of the market and tree; tickets were half price in the first hour of opening.

Via Toucan Travellers, Jess Ellis, Shea Jordan, HONEST GUIDE, Happy to Wander (Travel Tips & Inspo), Postcard And A Pint

Tower CZK 350, child CZK 230 (2026)

DETAILS

04



Petřín hill

MALÁ STRANA · GREAT FOR KIDS

A green hill above the Lesser Town with a funicular, a mini Eiffel Tower of 299 steps, a mirror maze and gardens - a good escape from the crowds with tired children.

Via CORR Travel Europe Your Way, Noah Travel Guides, Creative Travel Guide, Martijn Around The World - Travel

Tower CZK 250, child CZK 170 · funicular free for under-15s

DETAILS

05



Vyšehrad

VYŠEHRAD · GREAT FOR KIDS

The quieter castle: free to enter, with ramparts, river views, a famous cemetery and few tourists, reached by metro or tram.

Via Toucan Travellers, Camden David, Happy to Wander (Travel Tips & Inspo), Jenix Travel Vlogs

Free

DETAILS

06



Kampa, the Lennon Wall & Vojanovy sady

MALÁ STRANA · GREAT FOR KIDS

A small island park under Charles Bridge with David Černý's giant crawling babies, swans and river nutria (don't touch - they bite), the graffiti Lennon Wall nearby, and a free walled garden with peacocks.

Via Nash & Tereza, Martijn Around The World - Travel, Jumping Places, Ania & Greg's ADVENTURES, Happy to Wander (Travel Tips & Inspo)

Free

DETAILS

07



Photo: Altaipanther · Public domain

Prague Zoo

TROJA · GREAT FOR KIDS

One of Europe's best zoos, with a chairlift and children's zoo. Short winter hours (9:00-16:00) and ticket offices close early on 24 December. Cheaper online.

Via Noah Travel Guides, Real Prague Guides

Online CZK 300 adult, CZK 200 child, family CZK 850

DETAILS

08



Photo: VitVit · CC BY-SA 4.0

National Technical Museum

HOLEŠOVICE · GREAT FOR KIDS

Trains, cars and planes in a huge hall - a creators' pick for children on a cold day, near Letná Park.

Via Nash & Tereza

Check the site

DETAILS

09



Photo: Lehotsky · CC BY-SA 3.0

Jewish Quarter (Josefov)

JOSEFOV

Synagogues and the Old Jewish Cemetery on one combined ticket; they close early, so go in the early afternoon and allow a few hours.

Via The Traveler's Atlas, Creative Travel Guide, Exotic Vacation

About $16 combined (2025)

DETAILS

10

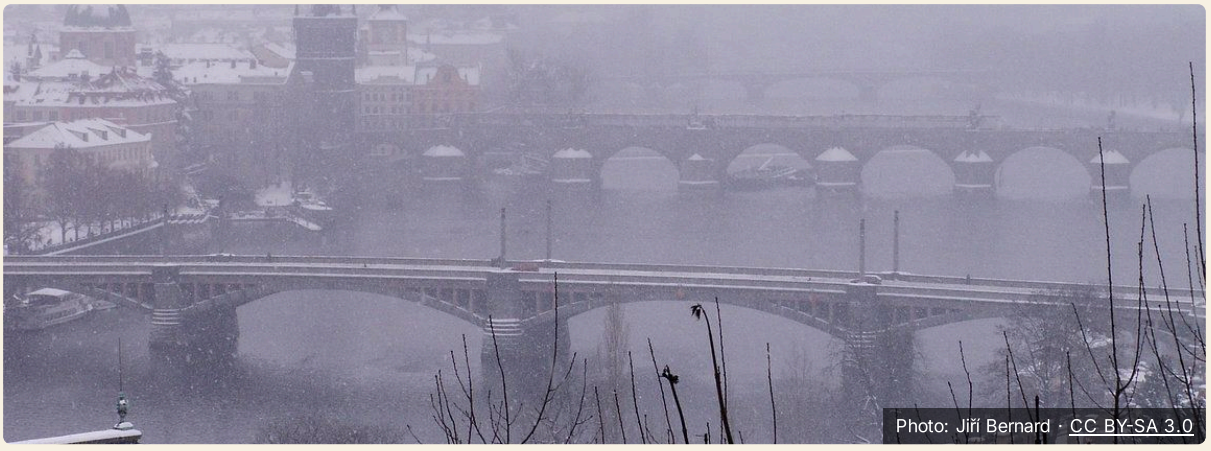


Photo: Jiří Bernard · CC BY-SA 3.0

Letná Park

HOLEŠOVICE · GREAT FOR KIDS

The best view of the bridges stepping down the river, with a beer garden (quieter in winter) and a giant metronome. Sunset favourite.

Via Birta Hlin, Visha Khandelwal, Exotic Vacation, Real Prague Guides

Free

DETAILS

If you only have one day

ONE

1

The classic loop

07:30 **Charles Bridge before the crowds.** Then up through Malá Strana, or tram 22 to the castle.

09:00 **Prague Castle.** Free courtyards, St Vitus and the noon changing of the guard.

12:30 **Lunch.** Lokál or a canteen - book or arrive early.

14:00 **Old Town Hall tower.** Views over the market, then the clock on the hour.

15:30 **Charles Bridge lamplighter.** Around 4pm in the weeks before Christmas.

16:30 **Old Town Square tree.** The light show every hour after dark; eat at the stalls or a side street.

18:30 **Wenceslas Square or Náměstí Míru.** More space, cheaper mulled wine - take the metro to Náměstí Míru.

Three days, grouped by area

DAY

1

Old Town

AM Astronomical Clock and tower early.

PM Jewish Quarter and the Old Town markets.

EVE Tree light show and Wenceslas Square market.

DAY

2

Castle & Lesser Town

AM Charles Bridge at sunrise, then the castle.

PM Kampa, the peacock garden and Petřín.

EVE Dinner in Malá Strana.

DAY

3

Like a local

AM Vyšehrad or the zoo.

PM Letná Park and the National Technical Museum.

EVE Náměstí Míru and Jiřího z Poděbrad markets in Vinohrady.

GOULASH, SVÍČKOVÁ AND CHRISTMAS CARP

Where to eat

Czech food is hearty: goulash with bread dumplings, svíčková (beef in a creamy vegetable sauce with cranberries), roast pork knuckle, fried cheese, and open sandwiches (chlebíčky) at Christmas. The traditional Christmas Eve dinner is fried carp with potato salad. Trdelník is a tourist invention - try a koláč from a bakery instead. Most proper meals are under CZK 300; prices carry the year.

Lokál

STARÉ MĚSTO & MALÁ STRANA · CZECH PUB

€€

The pub group that revived Czech pub food, with tank Pilsner and classics like pork with dumplings at non-tourist prices; a toddler happily ate the beef broth.

Family friendly Via Walshy's Travels, Gone Again, Max Nomad

VISIT

Havelská Koruna

STARÉ MĚSTO · SELF-SERVICE CANTEEN

€

About 25 Czech dishes a day; a soup, main and salad came to just under €12 (2026). Queue for about 20 minutes at lunch.

Family friendly Via GoPrague, Real Prague Guides

VISIT

Kantýna

NOVÉ MĚSTO · BUTCHER CANTEEN

€€

A self-service meat canteen in a former bank: you collect stamps on a card and pay on the way out. About CZK 750 for two (2025).

Family friendly Via Kristina's Travels

VISIT

Česká kuchyně

NOVÉ MĚSTO · CANTEEN

€ Old-school canteen popular with locals; arrive by 11:00-11:30 on weekdays before the queue.

Family friendly Via Dave Mani, Abroad and Hungry

VISIT

Parašutista

NEAR THE DANCING HOUSE · CZECH

€€ Affordable traditional food in big portions.

Family friendly Via Sara Goes Local

VISIT

U Dvou slunců

NERUDOVA, BELOW THE CASTLE · CZECH

€€ Roast duck with dumplings and cabbage, or fried cheese, on the climb to the castle - under CZK 300 a meal (2022).

Family friendly Via Real Prague Guides

VISIT

Mlýnec

BY CHARLES BRIDGE · FINE DINING

€€€ € Michelin-recommended with excellent service; lunch for two was under €80 (2026), more in the evening.

Grown-ups Via Real Prague Guides

VISIT

Bistro u Býka

BY THE POWDER TOWER · BUTCHER BISTRO

€

A Czech hot dog (párek v rohlíku) for CZK 69 (2025) - the budget lunch in the centre.

Family friendly Via Real Prague Guides

VISIT

Cukrář Skála

NOVÉ MĚSTO · CAKE SHOP

€

Retro Czech cakes such as větrník and indiánek - local guides call them the best in town.

Family friendly Via Real Prague Guides

VISIT

Manifesto Market

SMÍCHOV · FOOD HALL

€€

Food from around the world under one roof - good when the family can't agree. Card only.

Family friendly

Via Happy to Wander (Travel Tips & Inspo), Real Prague Guides, Martijn Around The World - Travel

VISIT

For a grown-ups' evening: a hot honey wine (medovina) or svařák at a local market, a half-litre of Pilsner in a Lokál pub, or last-minute opera tickets at the National Theatre - The Nutcracker sells out months ahead. Organised pub crawls are banned, and drinking in the street is illegal in much of the centre despite how it looks. Avoid touts at the bottom of Wenceslas Square. The drinking age is 18. Opening times and menus change, so check before you travel. Wiley Fox is not paid for restaurant listings.

BEFORE YOU GO

Getting around Prague

From the airport

There's no metro to the airport. Take trolleybus 59 to Nádraží Veleslavín (metro A) or bus 100 to Zličín (metro B) on a 90-minute ticket - CZK 46 in the app (2026) - about 30-40 minutes to the centre. The Airport Express to the main station is CZK 200 and only every 30 minutes. Fixed taxi fares ended on 1 October 2026; the airport puts a typical trip at about CZK 800, and app rides showed CZK 450-550.

Via HONEST GUIDE, Happy to Wander (Travel Tips & Inspo), Carol & Max, CORR Travel Europe Your Way, Brogan Tate

Tickets in 2026

Tickets are by time, valid on metro, trams, buses and ferries: 30 minutes CZK 36, 90 minutes CZK 46, 24 hours CZK 140, 72 hours CZK 340 in the PID Lítačka app (paper costs a little more). Validate paper tickets once; activate app tickets before boarding. A big suitcase may need its own ticket.

Via Carol & Max, Happy to Wander (Travel Tips & Inspo), LIKE A LOCAL, Real Prague Guides

Children and grandparents ride free

In Prague under-10s travel free, 10-15s free with proof of age, and over-65s free with ID - so a family usually needs only the adults' tickets.

Via LIKE A LOCAL, Creative Travel Guide

Trams and metro

Trams are the easiest way round - tram 22 runs past the National Theatre and Malá Strana almost to the castle gate. Several lines share each stop, so check the number. Metro runs about 5am to midnight; night trams every 30 minutes after that. Lifts serve most but not all metro stations - check before you go with a pushchair.

Via The Traveler's Atlas, Abby and Logan Travel, CORR Travel Europe Your Way, Chris Rodriguez

Petřín funicular

The funicular up Petřín hill reopened after renovation; it runs every 10 minutes and is free for under-15s and over-65s. Short PID tickets didn't cover it before the works - check your ticket, and validate once only: inspectors wait at the top.

Via Real Prague Guides, HONEST GUIDE

What it costs

30-minute ticket, Prague (app / paper)	**CZK 36 app, CZK 39 paper; reduced CZK 18 / 19** 2026 tariff from 1 Jan 2026
90-minute ticket, Prague (app / paper)	**CZK 46 app, CZK 50 paper; reduced CZK 23 / 25** 2026 tariff from 1 Jan 2026
24-hour ticket, Prague (app / paper)	**CZK 140 app, CZK 150 paper; reduced CZK 70 / 75** 2026 tariff from 1 Jan 2026
72-hour ticket, Prague (app / paper)	**CZK 340 app, CZK 350 paper; no reduced version** 2026 tariff from 1 Jan 2026
Airport bus 59 or 100 plus metro	**Uses a 90-minute ticket: CZK 46 app, CZK 50 paper** 2026 (airport page read 14 Oct 2026)
Airport Express (AE) to Main Railway Station	**CZK 200 one way; normal PID tickets not valid** Airport website, read 14 Oct 2026
Taxi, airport to city centre	**About CZK 800 typical (about 20 km); fares uncapped since 1 Oct 2026, so use an app showing total fare** Airport website, read 14 Oct 2026
Mulled wine (svarak), Old Town Square market	**CZK 100 for 2 dl; deposit amount not yet confirmed** Dec 2024 (2026 not yet confirmed)
Trdelnik, Old Town Square market	**CZK 100 to 180 plain or with toppings; CZK 190 with ice cream (Dec 2024)** Seznam Zpravy report states 2025 (publication date not independently confirmed); 2026 not yet confirmed
Klobasa (grilled sausage), Old Town Square market	**CZK 160; langos up to CZK 220** Dec 2024 (2026 not yet confirmed)
Old Prague ham at the markets (sold by weight)	**About CZK 99 per 100 g (another guide: about CZK 1 per gram). Trap: ask for a weight in grams, not a 'portion'; 200 g is roughly CZK 200** Undated private guide; 2026 not yet confirmed
Prague Castle Main Circuit (adult / child 6-16)	**Adult CZK 450; reduced CZK 300 (ages 6-16, students to 26, 65+); family CZK 950; under 6 free; valid 2 days** Official price list valid from 1 Mar 2024, still linked on hrad.cz on 12 Oct 2026; 2026 price not yet confirmed

Old Town Hall with Astronomical Clock tower	**Page lists basic CZK 350, reduced CZK 230 (ages 6-15, 65+), youth 16-26 CZK 280, under 5 free; exactly which route the basic ticket covers is not yet confirmed** Prague City Tourism page modified 14 Oct 2026
Petrin Lookout Tower	**Adult CZK 250; reduced CZK 170 (ages 6-15, 65+); family CZK 500; under 5 free; lift is a separate fee (CZK 150, CZK 50 for 65+)** Prague City Tourism page modified 30 Sep 2026
Petrin funicular	**CZK 100 single (CZK 90 via the app); free for under-15s and over-65s** Prague City Tourism page, read 14 Oct 2026; tariff year not printed
Prague Zoo (at till / online)	**Adult CZK 330 / 300; child 3-15 CZK 250 / 200; family (2 adults + 4 children) CZK 1,000 / 850; under 3 free** Official page read 14 Oct 2026; tariff year not printed
Half-litre beer in a pub	**CZK 55 to 80 in ordinary pubs; CZK 70 to 120 on Old Town terraces (private guides, not official)** 2026 (secondary sources)
Central hotel night in December	**Not yet confirmed - no reputable December-specific source found (Trip.com lists a yearly average of USD 249 for Prague hotels, not December-specific)** Not yet confirmed
Public toilet	**CZK 10 to 20 typical (private guide)** Year not printed; not yet confirmed officially
Exchange rate reference	**EUR 1 = CZK 24.375 (Czech National Bank). No pound rate found, so no GBP conversions given** 13 Oct 2026

Creator prices carry the video date. Anything older than 18 months is marked to check.

Quick tips

Pay by card, in koruna

Cards work almost everywhere. Always choose koruna when asked, avoid Euronet machines, and never change money on the street. Keep a few coins for toilets and the smaller markets, some of which are cash only.

Go early, and on weekdays

December is high season. Charles Bridge, the clock and the castle are calm at 7-8am and packed by mid-morning; the Old Town market is easier on a weeknight than at the weekend.

Use an app taxi

Bolt, Uber or Liftago show the price up front. Avoid street taxis at the main station, the airport rank and in the Old Town.

Ask the weight before they cut

Ham and other market food is sold per 100 g. Ask for a weight and the total, and check restaurant bills for service charges and extras.

Book dinners and concerts

Restaurants fill in December - book three or four days ahead - and The Nutcracker and other Christmas shows sell out months in advance. Buy from the venue's own site.

24 to 26 December

Large shops close at noon on 24 December and all day on 25 and 26 December, and many restaurants and sights close too; the castle buildings are shut on the 24th. The Old Town and Wenceslas Square markets stay open with shorter hours. Stock up by the 23rd if you're in an apartment.

WF

Found a bad exchange rate, a cash-only stall or a street that felt wrong? Drop a community report on the map - it helps the next family.

THE SMALL THINGS VISITORS WORRY ABOUT

Local tips for Prague

Every tip here was checked against an official or trusted source (Prague public transport, the airport, the Czech National Bank, Prague City Tourism, gov.uk and others) on the date shown. Rules and prices change, so tap the link to double-check before you travel.

Paying for transport

What do the main Prague public transport tickets cost in 2026?

From 1 January 2026 a full-fare ticket for the whole of Prague costs: 30 minutes CZK 36 (app) or CZK 39 (paper); 90 minutes CZK 46 or CZK 50; 24 hours CZK 140 or CZK 150; 72 hours CZK 340 or CZK 350. The app price is the cheaper one. One ticket covers metro, tram, bus and the other PID services in Prague. Checked 2026-10 ↗

Do my children need tickets in Prague?

Children under 6 travel free across the whole PID system if accompanied by someone over 10. Children aged 6 to 10 travel free in Prague, and children aged 10 to 15 travel free in Prague if they can prove their age (a document with name, date of birth and photo). Outside Prague, ages 6 to 15 pay half fare. Checked 2026-10 ↗

Do grandparents get free or cheaper travel?

Anyone aged 65 or over travels free on Prague metro, trams, buses and ferries, and only needs to show proof of age if inspected (passport or national ID). Ages 60 to 65 pay half price (a 24-hour ticket is CZK 75 on the Prague transport company's page). Checked 2026-10 ↗

Is a 24-hour or 72-hour pass worth it for a family?

Tickets are per person, but under-15s travel free in Prague, so a family of two adults and children needs only two adult tickets. Two adults on a 24-hour ticket cost CZK 280 (app, 2026). Single 90-minute tickets (CZK 46 each) are cheaper if you only make two or three trips. Checked 2026-10 ↗

What is the PID Lítačka app and does it work in English?

It is the official app for tickets, journey planning and closure alerts. It is available in

Can I tap my bank card on board?

PID says card payment in vehicles is an extra service, not guaranteed. If the terminal fails and you cannot pay another

English, takes cards, Apple Pay and Google Pay, and lets you buy now and activate later, or set a future start time. You need a data connection to activate a ticket, but not afterwards. Checked 2026-10 ↗

way, the driver may refuse to carry you, so have the Lítačka app or cash as a back-up. Whether you can tap in at metro stations or ticket machines is not yet confirmed.
Checked 2026-10 ↗

Do I have to stamp my ticket?

Yes for paper tickets: validate once at the first boarding (at the yellow validators in metro stations or at the airport platforms). App tickets must be activated before you board; the default countdown is 2 minutes. An unvalidated ticket counts as no ticket.
Checked 2026-10 ↗

What is the fine for travelling without a valid ticket?

In Prague the fine is CZK 1,200 on the spot, CZK 1,500 if paid within 15 days, or CZK 2,000 otherwise (2026). It drops to CZK 50 if you show a valid ticket or discount proof within 15 days. Checked 2026-10 ↗

How do I get from the airport on public transport?

Buy a 90-minute ticket (CZK 46 app or CZK 50 paper, 2026) before boarding. Take trolleybus 59 to Veleslavín (about 15 minutes) then metro line A, or bus 100 to Zličín (about 18 minutes) then metro line B. Night buses 907 and 910 take about 45 minutes to the centre. Checked 2026-10 ↗

What is the Airport Express and is it good value?

It is a bus from the airport to the Main Railway Station (about 40 minutes). A one-way ticket is CZK 200 (airport website, read 14 Oct 2026). Normal PID tickets are not valid on it. Buy from the Visitor Centre in arrivals or from the driver. For most families, 59 plus the metro is far cheaper.
Checked 2026-10 ↗

Which taxi or ride app should I use from the airport?

Use an app that shows the total fare before you confirm. The airport says Prague's taxi fare cap ended on 1 October 2026, so prices can now differ between firms. Its own figure for a typical trip to the centre (about 20 km) is around CZK 800. Uber Airport shows a fixed fare and is bound by limits agreed with the airport.
Checked 2026-10 ↗

Can I use the metro with a pushchair or wheelchair?

The transport company says lifts serve 45 stations, though another line on the same page says 48 of 61, so the count is unclear. Lifts can break down; check the live lift status page before you go. Stations without lifts are hard to use with a pushchair.
Checked 2026-10 ↗

Water & snacks

CHRISTMAS Is a trdelník a traditional Czech Christmas treat?

No. Wikipedia notes it is mostly described in older sources as Slovak or Moravian, and sellers only spread across Prague from the early 2000s. It is still popular and warm to hold. Typical prices were CZK 100 to 180 plain or with toppings (2025 report), and CZK 190 with ice cream (December 2024). Checked 2026-10 ↗

CHRISTMAS How much is mulled wine (svařák) at the Old Town market?

About CZK 100 for 2 decilitres at Old Town Square in December 2024. Wenceslas Square was CZK 100 to 120 and Náměstí Míru CZK 80 that year. 2026 prices are not yet confirmed. Checked 2026-10 ↗

CHRISTMAS What is the ham-by-weight trap at the market?

Old Prague ham is sold by weight, not by portion. A guide gives CZK 99 per 100 g, another about CZK 1 per gram, so 200 g is roughly CZK 200 (price undated). Ask for a weight in grams (for example 150 g) and watch it being weighed. Asking for a 'portion' leaves the price to the seller. Checked 2026-10 ↗

Is tap water safe to drink?

Yes. The city water company says Prague tap water meets Czech and European standards and is checked regularly. One caution: very old buildings with lead pipes can be a risk for small children and pregnant women, so ask your accommodation if you are in a pre-war building. Checked 2026-10 ↗

Toilets

Do public toilets cost money?

Often yes. Guides give CZK 10 to 20 per visit, including in metro stations, and a few take euros. Shopping centres and fast-food restaurants are often free or cheaper. Keep a few coins in your pocket. Private guide, no official fee list found. Checked 2026-10 ↗

Parks & play

CHRISTMAS *Are there free things for children at the markets?*

A tourism site lists creative decoration-making workshops for children at Old Town Square every Saturday and Sunday from 11:00 to 15:00. Whether they are free and the 2026 dates are not yet confirmed. The markets are free to enter and Wenceslas Square has an ice rink (fee not yet confirmed). Checked 2026-10 ↗

Is Prague Zoo worth visiting in winter?

Yes, but days are short. November and December hours are 9:00 to 16:00, ticket offices close earlier (15:30 weekends, 14:00 some weekday entrances) and on 24 December all ticket offices close at 14:00. The fur seal exhibit is closed on Fridays. The children's tram is out of service.

Checked 2026-10 ↗

What does Prague Zoo cost for a family?

At the till: adult CZK 330, child (3 to 15) CZK 250, family ticket CZK 1,000. Online e-tickets are cheaper: CZK 300, CZK 200 and CZK 850 (2 adults plus up to 4 children). Under-3s are free. Retirees pay CZK 150. Page read 14 Oct 2026; tariff year not printed. Checked 2026-10 ↗

What does Petřín tower and funicular cost?

The Petřín tower is CZK 250 (reduced CZK 170 for ages 6 to 15 and 65+, family CZK 500, under-5s free); its lift is a separate fee. The funicular is CZK 100 single, free for under-15s and over-65s. The tower is open 10:00 to 18:00 in November and December. A walk or funicular suits tired children.

Checked 2026-10 ↗

Money & tipping

What currency do I use, and can I pay in euros?

Prague uses the Czech koruna (CZK). The Czech National Bank published EUR 1 = CZK 24.375 for 13 October 2026. Shops are not required to take euros; some tourist places do at poor rates. Pay in koruna wherever you can. Checked 2026-10 ↗

Where is it safe to change money?

Change money only at a designated bureau de change, never from people on the street. The Czech National Bank also says rates vary a lot between offices, so compare the buy and sell rates before you go in.

Checked 2026-10 ↗

What is the 'no commission' or '0%' trap?

Can I change my mind after exchanging money?

Czech law bans commission on currency exchange, so '0% commission' means nothing. The real cost is hidden in the gap between buy and sell rates. The central bank says a gap of several koruna is a reason not to proceed. A tourist-centre kiosk can leave you well short of the fair rate. Checked 2026-10 ↗

Yes, within 3 hours at the same bureau (the clock pauses outside its opening hours). You are entitled to a written proof of cancellation in at least Czech and English. For amounts over EUR 1,000 you can cancel only the first EUR 1,000. Machines allow 3 working days. Checked 2026-10 ↗

Should I pay in koruna or pounds on a card machine or cash machine?

Choose koruna. If a cash machine or card terminal offers to charge you in pounds, that is dynamic currency conversion and it usually gives a worse rate. A 2026 local guide specifically warns about this at airport cash machines. Checked 2026-10 ↗

CHRISTMAS *Will cards be accepted?*

Prague Zoo says all its ticket offices take payment cards, and some Prague City Tourism towers take card only. Card acceptance at individual Christmas market stalls is not yet confirmed, so carry some koruna for stalls and toilets.

Checked 2026-10 ↗

How much should I tip?

Tipping is customary rather than required. About 10 percent for good service, or rounding up the bill, is typical. Check whether a service charge is already on the bill first. This comes from private guides, not an official source. Checked 2026-10 ↗

Phones & data

Will my UK phone cost extra in Prague?

It depends on your plan. A September 2026 comparison says O2 does not charge for EU roaming (up to 25 GB), EE and Vodafone charge about GBP 2.50 a day and Three GBP 2.75. Older contracts may differ, so check your own plan or buy an eSIM before you go. Checked 2026-10 ↗

Safety habits

How do I avoid taxi problems in the city?

The UK Foreign Office advises using a major taxi company rather than hailing one in the street, and checking the rates on the side of the car before you get in. Beware of unmarked cars posing as taxis. If a fare looks excessive, or no receipt is offered, do not pay and call the Municipal Police on 156. Checked 2026-10 ↗

Where do pickpockets work?

The UK Foreign Office warns of pickpockets on airport transport into town, trams to Prague Castle and busy tourist areas. A 2026 local guide names tram 22, Charles Bridge and Old Town Square. Tram 9 is not yet confirmed. Keep phones in front pockets or zipped bags, and be extra careful in market crowds. Checked 2026-10 ↗

What if someone says they are police and asks to see my cash?

The UK Foreign Office warns of fake plainclothes police. Offer to go to a police station, or call 112 to check. Real officers will not mind. Checked 2026-10 ↗

Where is it risky at night?

A 2026 local guide says a cluster of bars at the bottom of Wenceslas Square use pushy touts and have been linked to overcharging and, rarely, spiked drinks. Do not follow touts, check prices first, and use an app taxi to get home. Checked 2026-10 ↗

Who do I call in an emergency?

112 for any emergency. Police 158, ambulance 155, fire and rescue 150, city (municipal) police 156. Report theft at a police station within 24 hours for a crime number for insurance; the central station at Jungmannovo náměstí 9 is open 24 hours with interpreters. Checked 2026-10 ↗

What do UK travellers need at the border?

Your passport must be under 10 years old at arrival and valid for 3 months after you leave. The EU Entry/Exit System is being introduced: you may have fingerprints and a photo taken on your first visit (free; children 11 and under are not fingerprinted). Allow extra time. Hotels normally register you with the police within 3 days. Checked 2026-10 ↗

Do I need an ETIAS?

Not yet. The EU's official site (read 14 Oct 2026) says ETIAS is not in operation and no applications are taken. The start date will be announced several months ahead, so

check again before you book.

Checked 2026-10 ↗

Local ways

CHRISTMAS When are shops shut over Christmas 2026?

Shops over 200 square metres must close by 12:00 on Thursday 24 December and stay shut all day on Friday 25 and Saturday 26 December. Petrol stations, pharmacies, small shops and shops in stations and airports are exempt. Buy supplies by Wednesday 23 December. Checked 2026-10 ↗

CHRISTMAS Are shops closed on Sundays and on 1 January?

The Christmas rules come from a law banning sales in larger shops on seven public holidays. We did not confirm the full list for 2026, so check whether 1 January 2027 is included. We found no source for a general Sunday ban; assume small shops open. Checked 2026-10 ↗

CHRISTMAS When do the Christmas markets run in 2026?

Old Town Square and Wenceslas Square markets run from 28 November 2026 to 6 January 2027, daily, with Wenceslas Square 10:00 to 22:00 and free entry. A tourism site says both are open on 24 and 25 December and New Year's Eve. Hours on those specific days are not yet confirmed.

Checked 2026-10 ↗

CHRISTMAS What is the weather like in December?

Typical highs are about 4 degrees Celsius with nights around 0 to minus 2, and it can be colder. Daylight is about 8.5 hours with sunset around 16:00 to 16:30. Pack waterproof boots, gloves and warm layers; cobbles get slippery. Checked 2026-10 ↗

CHRISTMAS Can we set off fireworks on New Year's Eve?

Not in the historic centre. A Prague city rule bans fireworks and firecrackers in the heritage reserve, within 50 metres of the river, in parks and near hospitals. On-the-spot fines go up to CZK 10,000 (up to CZK 100,000 in formal proceedings). The city did not plan an official fireworks show for

New Year 2026. New Year 2027 plans are not yet confirmed. Checked 2026-10 ↗

Travel with Wiley Fox

Official travel advice for 200+ countries, community reports, one-tap SOS, and QR wristbands so lost children and lost bags find their way back.

CREDITS

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